detached from the insecurities and rewards of postings and work with courage of conviction, and concentrate on doing your best in whichever post you are. After all, you will still be in the city of Delhi.'

The experiences of some officers, after having been posted in various police stations, revealed the ground realities. One woman officer recounted how crimes were trivialized: 'I was posted in a police station as a duty officer. A complainant reported that he had been robbed at knife point by a group of pickpockets while on a bus.' Consequently, she went up to her station house officer and said: 'Sir, I would need to register a case of robbery.' The SHO replied: 'Nothing doing.' He instead advised her to treat the incident as a scuffle that led to the loss of a few hundred rupees and some scratches on his body. When this officer declined to oblige, she was shifted to patrolling and picket duties. The case was then minimized and the criminals got away. After that, for many months, she was not given any assignment as a duty officer. She said she did not mind what happened to her but pointed out that such was the state of affairs.

Another young officer recounted how he was being compelled to make out a case against a builder by his seniors so that they could 'extract' something from him. When this officer refused to oblige, he was threatened with punishment. (Fortunately, this threat remained just that: only a threat.) Yet another instance was when a father came to report that his thirteen-year-old daughter had been forcibly taken away by a neighbour's son. Instead of registering a case of kidnapping, a 'missing' report was lodged. There were many more such incidents that revealed how freshly trained officers were resisting becoming a part of the existing system. Moral and ethical training had instilled in many of them a sense of justice and fair play. But one wondered for how long would these noble qualities last?

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Meanwhile, dissatisfaction and impatience were eroding the morale of trainees at those centres of the Delhi Police that were not under Kiran's supervision. Training in Delhi Police was, unfortunately, disjointed. These trainees had started to petition the authorities that they should also get interactive, state-of-the-art training just like their counterparts in the Police Training College at Jharoda Kalan. They justifiably asked as to why they were left out. Consequently, Police Commissioner Ajai Raj Sharma sought the assessment of his colleague Special Commissioner (Administration) R. K. Sharma and directed him to visit these centres. The report submitted by R. K. Sharma confirmed the grievances expressed by the trainees. An order integrating the training centres soon followed. As a result, Kiran had to supervise two other centres as well. All induction and promotional courses were brought under her supervision as joint commissioner of police (training). This decision was long overdue but was perhaps not taken earlier because there was no compelling reason, no grievances and no comparisons between the training procedures at different centres.

Within hours of assuming the additional responsibility, Kiran took some major steps. She pulled out 51 recruit trainees from a centre (where the living conditions were subhuman) and lodged them at the Police Training College. Here, they were given further training, and all the resources were made available to them. With 151 women constables on the verge of being promoted as head constables, she took the decision to shift the focus from theory to practical training when most of them complained that they had no knowledge of *actual* police work despite the three months of training that they had already undergone. In small batches, all of them were attached to police stations to observe and study the practical aspects of policing under a guide deputed for them. The practical training included learning computer skills at the nearest computer training centre.

But the most important step Kiran took, which perhaps was all she could do within the ambit of her